

Ryan G. Wilson

UX Leader, Product Practice Builder, Hands-On Designer & Front-End Developer — nearly 25 years of experience

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UX and Product leader who has built design and product practices from zero, twice: at Callibrity, growing the Product Practice from a single founding hire into a nine-person team; earlier at Bitovi, rebuilding a two-person team into ten while growing UX consulting sales from \$1M to \$2.5M in two years. Still hands-on by choice: builds design systems and component libraries personally, ships accessible and responsive production front ends, and speaks publicly on accessibility. Author of a company-wide AI-enablement standard built on a human-decision-authority principle: AI accelerates the work, people make the decisions. An early adopter of AI-assisted design-to-code workflows. Experienced designing multi-persona, workflow-heavy platforms across enterprise, nonprofit, and community-facing work.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Director of Product, Callibrity, Nov 2023 – Present

- Founding individual contributor of Callibrity's Product Practice; grew it into a nine-person team by recruiting and mentoring each hire, while remaining a practicing designer
- Authored and rolled out a company-wide AI-enablement standard grounded in a human-decision-authority principle: AI accelerates production work, people make the decisions
- Built the design system, component library, and production front end for FEG and for CHIRP Radio (nonprofit), applying an AI-assisted design-to-code methodology across both engagements
- Directed a compressed engagement for a confidential funds management firm: a three-person team took a Figma-paired, Storybook-documented component library from design tokens to a full production front end in thirteen weeks
- Led client strategy and delivery for organizations including Honda HALO, FlyWire, GE Aerospace, and Town of Cary
- Built a Product Consultant career ladder tied to impact, growth, and engagement, and rebuilt the quarterly review process around it

Product Experience Lead, LPL Financial, Jul 2023 – Nov 2023

- Collaborated cross-functionally to align on product vision, define strategy, and incorporate user insights into roadmap and prioritization
- Brought human-centered design rigor to financial digital products through iterative testing and accessible design standards

Principal UX Consultant, SimpleThread, Sep 2022 – Jul 2023

- Led product strategy, design, and delivery for healthcare and utility sector clients
- Served as an embedded leader in client teams to bridge design, development, and business needs

Senior Product Consultant, Kroger, Aug 2021 – Sep 2022

- Directed discovery and solution definition, as part of a three-person team, for the software Kroger uses to receive \$28 billion in direct-store-delivery product every year
- Conducted field research and built user flows and prototypes to reduce friction in Direct Store Delivery (DSD) workflows

Director of User Experience, Bitovi, Jun 2019 – Aug 2021

- Took over a two-person design team and rebuilt it deliberately, headcount and infrastructure together, growing it to ten people and UX sales from \$1M to \$2.5M in two years while holding utilization above 90%
- Recruited, mentored, and managed the team; led internal operations and process improvement
- Delivered engagements with Apple, Lowe's, Yum! Brands, and Winklevoss Capital

Senior User Experience Consultant, Bitovi, May 2016 – Jun 2019

- Delivered end-to-end product design for B2B and B2C clients; led workshops, wireframes, usability tests, and Agile ceremonies
- Led UX for a multi-entity Yum! Brands engagement, building a single menu management tool for Pizza Hut, Taco Bell, and KFC, replacing three separate brand-specific systems

Previous Roles: Assistant Professor, Graphic Design (Marshall University); Graphic Design Instructor (Iowa State University); Art Director; Director of Creative Services

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

am-ui, Self-directed, ongoing

- Zero-dependency component library with 44 production components and a live Figma-to-code token bridge with CI-enforced drift detection; built in one week, maintained on an ongoing basis

Conference Speaker, Accessibility, AHFE (Applied Human Factors and Ergonomics), Nice 2024 and Orlando 2025

CORE SKILLS

Practice Building: recruiting, mentoring, and leveling teams; career-ladder design; scalable process frameworks

Design Systems & Component Libraries: Figma (components, design tokens, interactive prototypes), am-ui

AI-Augmented Workflows: authored and rolled out a company-wide AI-enablement standard; AI-assisted design-to-code methodology

Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA hands-on validation, accessible pattern design; conference speaker on accessibility

Front-End Fluency: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, used to build responsive production front ends (desktop, tablet, mobile)

Research & Synthesis: personas, product flows, workshop facilitation, discovery

Analytics & Measurement: quantitative and qualitative usability testing data used to drive product decisions; working familiarity with Google Analytics and Hotjar

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Human Computer Interaction, Iowa State University, College of Engineering, 2015

Master of Fine Arts (MFA), Graphic Design, Iowa State University, College of Design, 2014

Master of Science (MS), Human Computer Interaction, Iowa State University, College of Engineering, 2012

Bachelor of Science (BS), Interactive Multimedia, Ohio University, School of Visual Communication, 2001